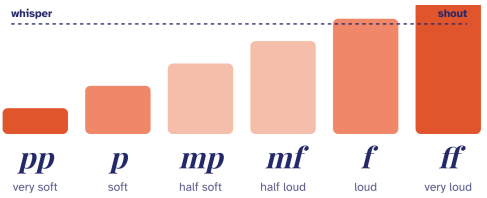
EXPRESSION · LOUD AND SOFT · LEARN

Loud and soft



REMEMBER pp p mp mf f ff: from a whisper to a shout. **m** (mezzo) means half; a second letter means very.

1 Say it ★☆☆

Write the Italian name and what it means. The first row is done.

SIGN	NAME	MEANS
p	piano	soft
mf		
ff		
mp		
pp		
f		

2 Soft to loud ★☆☆

Write these six signs in order, from the softest to the loudest: *mf* *pp* *f* *p* *ff* *mp*. The first is done.

pp ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

3 Louder or softer? ★☆☆

Does the music get louder or softer from the first sign to the second? The first is done.

mp → mf	**louder** · softer
f → p	louder · softer
pp → mp	louder · softer
ff → mf	louder · softer
p → f	louder · softer

4 Play it ★☆☆

Play Middle C six times: pp, p, mp, mf, f, ff. Six different steps? Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____
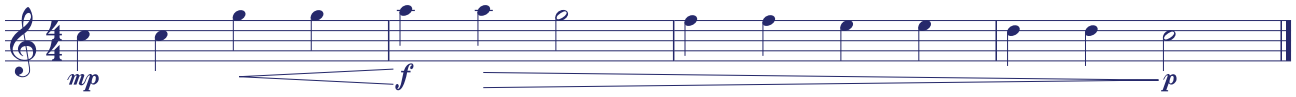
EXPRESSION · LOUD AND SOFT · USE

Loud and soft

REMEMBER A hairpin that opens grows louder (cresc.); one that closes fades (dim.).

1 Read the hairpins ★★☆

Look at the music and complete each sentence. The first is done.



It starts [mp] (sign).

The loudest note is in bar [ ] , marked [ ] .

It ends [ ] (sign).

2 Signs and words ★☆☆

Write what each one asks you to do. The first is done.

SIGN	WHAT YOU DO
cresc.	getting louder, little by little
dim.	
sfz	
fp	
subito p	

3 True or false? ★☆☆

Circle T or F.

mf is louder than mp.	T F
A crescendo also gets faster.	T F
A dynamic lasts until the next one.	T F
sfz makes one note suddenly strong.	T F

4 Play it ★☆☆

Play C D E F G growing from p to f, then come down fading to p, without speeding up. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____